

Interviewer: Ayan. Okay, so again, good evening people and thank you so much for your participation. So we'll get through the interview guide. So we'll start off with your demographics, can you tell me how old are you?

Speaker: I'm currently [16-20] years old turning [21-25] next month and yes.

Interviewer: Advanced happy birthday.

Speaker: Thank you.

Interviewer: Okay, so how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: [1-5] month, almost [1-5] months.

Interviewer: Okay, so do you have any children now?

Speaker: Ah, none.

Interviewer: Okay, so with that, who lives in the household or where do you currently live?

Speaker: It's just me, my mom, dad and my niece.

Interviewer: Okay, so you're staying with your family?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay, how about your partner?

Speaker: Partner like?

Interviewer: Where does he live?

Speaker: He has a job there. There's a [location] so he lives [location].

Interviewer: Okay, so what is your main source of income at the moment? Or do you have any current job?

Speaker: Ah none, I don't have any means in income since I live with my parents and then studying. [1st-4th] year college pa.

Interviewer: Okay, so how would you like us to address your partner? How would you like us to address [Partner's Name] throughout the interview?

Speaker: [Partner's Name] .

Interviewer: [Partner's Name] lang.

Interviewer: Okay, thank you. Let's start with your love story, of course. Can you tell me about your love story?

Speaker: It's not that romantically since these are [occupation] here in [Company], [Location]. And I just joined being a [occupation] last year and it didn't went well at first since some [occupation] told us na his kick lagay. Okay, so when we were working at [occupation], he instructed us, then he was very strict. But along the way, since I was young, he was here.

At first. Tapos, he didn't chat me for two weeks. He said na, he'll give me some space to think about it. Then, after noon na nga nga chat kami ulit. And then, yung, we clicked. Click na after.

Interviewer: So, after you said yes na.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay, so with that, how would you compare your relationship to that of your friends' relationship? With your relationship with [Partner's Name]?

Speaker: My relationship with my friends' relationship.

Interviewer: So yung relationship niya ni [Partner's Name] , how would you compare it to your friends' romantic relationship then?

Speaker: It's not the same since [Partner's Name] is, I can call him a mature one na it's not the same as some guy na my friends in a romantic relationship na. He's much more mature than me and he can understand me well. While my friends, I don't understand them because hindi sila magkaintindihan, they're not on the same wavelength.

Interviewer: Okay. So can I also ask have you had any romantic relationships in the past? Before that, how many?

Speaker: [1-5]. [Partner's Name] is the [1st-5th].

Interviewer: Okay. So with that, how would you compare the quality of relationship with [Partner's Name] to that of the first [1-5]?

Speaker: My relationship with [Partner's Name] now is much easier than I've had before. Since [Partner's Name], I can say na my relationship with [Partner's Name] right now can really light up my day compared with my past relationship. Kay instead of mga maging okay yung ano ko day ko, mas madadagdagan pa yung problema compared sa relationship namin ni [Partner's Name] ngayon.

Interviewer: Okay. So with that, it's somehow better.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Than your previous relationship. Okay. So what makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker: For me, being honest with each other since I'm respectful. Since with that, we can understand each other more if the honesty and respect is above your relationship. Since relationship is not all about happiness and may mga ano din. Pero feel ko kung honest kayo sa isa't isa, mas magiging okay yung relationship.

Interviewer: Okay. So what adjectives can you, what adjectives for you ang synonyms na high quality relationship? Or what best describes a high quality relationship?

Speaker: I couldn't think of the moment.

Interviewer: Okay. It's okay. It's okay. No problem. But how about low quality? So what makes a relationship low quality?

Speaker: Siguro pag hindi nyo napag-usapan yung problema nyo. Like yung nagagalit ka, nagagalit din siya. So instead na pag-usapan nyo, matutulog na lang kayo na galit kayo sa isa't-isa.

Interviewer: Okay. Why do you say so, bakit gan'unn yung description mo with low quality relationship?

Speaker: Sa'kin, I experience it po kasi last time.. So I can totally say na it's not making us grow as a partner, but nagdowngrade kami. Like, yes.

Interviewer: I see. Okay. So with that, would you say that high quality relationships are honest or honest relationship?

Interviewer: So how do you know when one, when one is in an honest relationship?

Speaker: I think when one is in an honest relationship, siguro pag, pag ano, pag, what do you call this? Pag napagsasabihan mo siya ng problema without any judgment na natatanggap. Like you can tell him or her everything na yun. Hindi hindi ka niya jina-judge instead of chinicheer ka niya and ano. And you do, you do to him as well din naman. Like understand each other lang. No lies kahit white lies.

Interviewer: I see. Okay. So would you say that your relationship with [Partner's Name] is of high quality?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: When was it in least quality or in low quality or if there are instances?

Speaker: With [Partner's Name]. Ah, wala pa naman po.

Interviewer: Wala pa. Okay. Sige. So with that for you, since we're diving into relationships, so what are the most important things in our relationship?

Speaker: As what I've said po, the respect na ibibigay nyo sa isa't isa. Since kayong dalawa yung bumubuo sa relationship niyo, so you should both respect each other. Example for us po ni [Partner's Name] since we have different religion. So we're both respecting each other din. Ako may work, ay si [Partner's Name] may work, ako may study. So respect each other's time and yun po.

Interviewer: Okay. Sige. So let's get a bit different. So for you, what is love?

Speaker: Love. For me, love is not all about happiness too. Like since when you love a person, it's not all about the good side but also accepting his bad side. Loving his bad side. Being with him or her through ups and downs. I guess yun lang as of now.

Interviewer: So for you, how important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: I guess it's important but not that really. Since I've watched some vlogs na like in a couple of vlogs na you can't love the person every day. Or you can't give love to a person every day or every time. Na 50-50 yung love or 75-25. So it's not that, for me, it's important but not that really po.

Interviewer: Okay. So if you were to rank, so you mentioned that the most important is respect for each other and each other's time. So love is a bit below. Would you say that love is a bit below respect when it comes to the important things in a relationship?

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: Okay. So how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: It makes me feel love. I can feel it, I can see it. Yes.

Interviewer: So would you mind telling concrete examples? In what way?

Speaker: [Partner's Name] has a lot of love languages kasi po. Like giving gifts, physical thought, words of affirmation. And yes, I can say that he loves me through that. With what he does through his love languages.

Interviewer: So what would you say are challenges in your relationship? Or do you have any?

Speaker: As of the moment, open lang kami sa side ni [Partner's Name]. Since my parents told me na hindi pa ko pwede mag-boyfriend. And also our religion. I think that would be our most challenging decision na mag-decide kami. Whether among religion namin in the future.

Interviewer: Would you mind if I ask, what religions do you have?

Speaker: I'm [Religion] then, siya [Religion].

Interviewer: Okay. So do you and [Partner's Name] fight? Or were there already instances of fighting in the relationship?

Speaker: Sometimes, if fights.

Interviewer: So how often would you say these fights are?

Speaker: Once a month. Hindi kasi kami masyadong nag-aaway. Minsan lang, 'pag tinotoyo.

Interviewer: Okay. So how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker: Ahm, we talk po. Like, ano 'yung nagawa niya, ano yung mga ginawa niya para makafeel ako ganon. Then we talk about it naman po. Tapos magsosorry kami with each other. Hindi kami matutulog na may problema. Inaayos talaga namin.

Interviewer: Okay. That's good. So aside from talking, which somehow is under communication. So aside from communication, what are other ways that you maintain the relationship? So what are other ways that you do or [Partner's Name] does or the relationship has to maintain the relationship?

Speaker: I guess po, if magsama kami. Kasi always po kami nagsasama. Halos every day. Ano lang. Saturday, Sunday, minsan hindi. Or pag may duty siya ganon. Understanding lang po talaga. Understanding. We understand each other.

Interviewer: Okay. That's good. So would you say that the relationship is good for you?

Speaker: I can say po. My relationship with [Partner's Name] is good for me.

Interviewer: So in what way?

Speaker: In a way na he can fix my mood. He can lighten up my mood every day. Especially now, I'm a third year college student. Struggling with my acads. Tapos, every time magrarant ako sa kanya. He does everything to light up my day. Cheer me up. And ginagawa ko rin yun sa kanya.

Interviewer: Okay. So you mentioned that you have different priorities at the moment. Since [Partner's Name] is working and you're studying. So would you say that there's also a support with your everyday activities since you're both at different fields at the moment?

Speaker: I can say po. Since [Partner's Name], if may, may hindi ako maintindihan sa class ko, nagpapahelp ako sa kanya. Then ano, since I'm also a [occupation], minsan pag may training siya nagpapasama siya or nagpapatulong siya. Vice versa helping siya.

Interviewer: So with simple tasks around your spare field.

Interviewer: Okay. So with that, can you say or did the relationship change you?

Speaker: Yes po. Yes. Hindi ko talaga ako yung tipo ng palausap. Same kami grumpy. But when we start the relationship, like yun, happy na ko. Magaan siya sa feeling. Hindi na siya yung mabigat, like everyday gumigising ka na, parang wala lang. Pero after na, naging kami ni [Partner's Name], may gana ka nang gumising araw-araw.

Interviewer: So how about your partner? Did they change during the relationship?

Speaker: Yes po. They really did. Tapos hindi lang ako yung nakaano, nakapansin. So mga tao rin nakapaligid sa amin.

Interviewer: So in what way?

Speaker: Other [occupation]s. So same sa sinabi ko po. Grumpy talaga si [Partner's Name] po. Mag-good morning kami sa kanya. Good morning, Kuya [Partner's Name]. Gaganyan lang siya. Tapos, hindi na kami napapansinin. May sarili siyang world. Kahit madami kami sa paligid niya. Nakatuon lang yun siya sa laptop or sa [Game Name]. Pero nung nags-start na, ano, na, nag-ano kami. Nag-ano kami, nagsasama. Palagi na siyang nakasmile, ngumingiti, kumakausap na ng ibang [occupation]. Like gan'un, magaan na siya sa ibang [occupation]s compared noon.

Interviewer: So he changed not only in your perspective, but also to the other [occupation].

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: Okay. So, um, um, is your partner the same before the relationship as they are now?

Speaker: Siguro sakin about the change, he's very consistent po.

Interviewer: In what ways does he show his consistency?

Speaker: Um, uh, first time nag-confess siya sa'kin. Last month ba 'yun? Tapos every now and then, yung, yung ginagawa niya noon, ginagawa niya pa rin ngayon. And yung yung, ano, um, I liked about him, his consistency po.

Interviewer: Okay. So you mentioned na, last, last month siya nag-confess. So that's, [Month]?

Speaker: Ay hindi, [Month] pala

Interviewer: So, [Month] siya nagconfess, and then yung got, um, yung got together, [Month].

Speaker: Last month. [Month]. [Month].

Interviewer: Okay. I see, I see. So, um, another aspect since we're talking about identity, changing, do you feel that the relationship is safe? Do you feel safe in the relationship?

Speaker: Yes, I feel safe.

Interviewer: Talaga, in what way?

Speaker: Even though, hindi pa ako open sa family namin. I feel safe, being with him. Kainsan kami kumunta.

Interviewer: Okay, so, um, how about, how about opening up? Can you open up to him?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Okay, so, not only physical safe. So, mayroon din, you can open up freely. You can open up freely.

Speaker: Wait lang po. Mahina po yung internet po.

Interviewer: Sige, sige, sige.

Speaker: Wait lang po. Hindi ko na kayo marinig, wait lang.

Interviewer: Okay, okay, no problem.

Speaker: Ayan.

Interviewer: So not only physical safe, so you also feel safe opening up. Yes. Emotionally. So, do you mind if I ask what do you usually open up to [Partner's Name]? If you don't mind.

Speaker: Some family problems, like fights or some friends fights, like, like sa very close people ko lang inano. Hindi kasi ako mas share sa ibang tao. But when [Partner's Name] came, I started to open up.

Interviewer: Okay. How about offering comfort or before it?

Speaker: Yes po. [Partner's Name]'s my [Name].

Interviewer: [Partner's Name]'s your?

Speaker: [Character].

Interviewer: [Character]. Okay. Okay. So, I'll be showing you a quick presentation. So, let me just share my screen. Kita naman. So, I'll be showing you a short scale lang. In this statement, so, you'll just rate it from one to nine with not at all true and completely true. So, ayan. My partner usually really listens to me. How would you rate this?

Speaker: Nine.

Interviewer: So, completely true. Before we discuss about it, how about this one? My partner usually is responsive to my needs.

Speaker: Nine.

Interviewer: Nine din.

Interviewer: Okay. So, I'll stop share for a while. Okay. So, you answered nine for both statements. Okay. So, why did you answer nine for the first item? So, yung first item is my partner usually really listens to me.

Speaker: Yes, lahat ng rants ko. Parang siyang notebook? Or naaano lang talaga niya. Kini-keep in mind niya talaga lahat ng nirarant ko. Then the second one, my needs like food. Ay, hindi kasi talaga ako materialistic. Like, excuse me po.

Interviewer: Okay. No problem.

Speaker: Sorry po. So, in terms of food, in terms of food like pag magcrave ako ng food, tomorrow or later binibili niya or pupunta kami dun para kumain.

Interviewer: Okay. So, for item number one about listening, so you rated nine. Why not seven or eight?

Speaker: Nine. Nine kasi he just listens then ano. He won't judge me. Like, and he really listens to me.

Interviewer: Okay. So, how about the second question? So, responsive to your needs. Why not seven or eight?

Speaker: Kasi po, kahit wala na kami pera, kung ano yung gusto po or ang gusto niya na kainin talaga namin, mabili talaga namin.

Interviewer: Okay. So, going the extra mile just to address your needs, parang gan'on.

Interviewer: Okay. So, the next question I hope you don't mind if I ask it and feel free to say if it's too sensitive but of course we also want to know your physical intimacy as a couple. So, on these days, how often do you have sex?

Speaker: We haven't.

Interviewer: We haven't, okay. But, do you mind if I ask about your physical intimacy?

Speaker: Clingy kami po.

Interviewer: Okay. But, nothing towards sex or malapit na?

Speaker: Malapit na.

Interviewer: It's okay. Okay. So, you're very, you're physically close, physically intimate. Okay. So, how satisfied are you with your sex life?

Speaker: Uh-huh. Since we haven't done sex. Uh-huh. But, satisfied naman.

Interviewer: Okay. So, with that, I'll show you another scale for another item. So, this is about in general, so we're nearing the end of the interview. So, let me just share it real quick. Okay. Visible?

Speaker: Ah, yes po.

Interviewer: Okay. So, ayan. In general, so with all these in mind, how satisfied are you with your relationship?

Speaker: Um, completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Completely satisfied. Okay. So, since you mentioned you're completely satisfied, let me show another one. Ayan. Since you mentioned that you're completely satisfied with your relationship. So, how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? So, let's talk about numbers. So, from 0 to 10...

Speaker: It's 10. 10.

Interviewer: Completely satisfied. In general, talaga. Okay. So, with that, why do you say so? So, you answered 10 for both, for both question.

Speaker: In my relationship, I couldn't ask for more. Since, what I like in a relationship is, eto ko ngayon. Yung pang in a relationship is nangyari siya with [Partner's Name]. So, I can say na, I'm completely satisfied with my relationship.

Interviewer: So, similar to to the scales that I showed before. So, why not 8 or 9?

Speaker: Hindi ko mabigyan nang less, less than 10. Since, I can totally say talaga na, I'm very satisfied, completely satisfied with our relationship right now.

Interviewer: Okay. No problem. So, with that, did the relationship fulfill your expectation?

Speaker: Yes. Hindi po kasi ako masyadong nag-eexpect sa relationship, so I just go with the flow, kung ano 'yung nangyayari ngayon, since we both don't know kung ano 'yung mangyayari sa future. So, just live kung ano 'yung ngayon. Then, let's press the bridge when we get there sa kung anong mangyayari sa...

Interviewer: But as of the moment, so without thinking about the future, does it fulfill your current expectations?

Speaker: Yes naman. Since I've said na kung ano yung, gusto ko sa isang relationship is yun yung ano namin ngayon ni [Partner's Name].

Interviewer: Okay, so that's good to hear. So we're close to wrapping up and before we end, I would like to summarize what you mentioned throughout the interview. So I'll be providing a quick summary for each question. So starting off with demographics, you are [16-20] years old and the relationship is [1-5] month, so almost [1-5] months. And currently do not have any children and in terms of your living conditions, you live with your family and then your partner [Partner's Name] lives in the [location]. And then you have no source of income since you're currently studying and living with your parents. So as for your love story, [Partner's Name] is your [occupation] in [Company] and you joined last year as a [occupation], didn't go well at first but over time, your first impression of [Partner's Name] was somehow strict and grumpy. But then you got along after some time and then he confessed and then you said no at first. But he gave you some time to think about it. But then you clicked and you said yes.

Interviewer: Okay, so in terms of your relationship quality, am I still audible? Am I still audible? Sorry. As for your relationship quality, comparing it with your friends, it's not the same since [Partner's Name] is mature and [Partner's Name] is different from the type of guys your friends have relationships with. So your friends' relationships are not on the same wavelength. But your relationship now is easier because he lights up your day. And then as for what makes our relationship high quality, you mentioned that it's all about honesty and respect as well as understanding and then low quality if you're not matched. So

you're not making each other grow in the relationship. So for you, the most important things in a relationship is respect to each other, your time and differences. Since you mentioned that you have different religions and then as of now you're studying and [Partner's Name] is working. And then as for your conceptualization of love, it's not all about happiness and the good time. But love is not that important because you can't love the person every day. But you know that your partner loves you because you feel it and he makes you feel love through his love languages.

Interviewer: And then as for challenges, current challenges in the relationship, family is a bit of a challenge for you and religion since you both have different religions. So you fight for petty reasons for a start but you talk about it and apologize as well. And aside from communication, you also understand each other and where you're coming from. And then the relationship is good for you as you mentioned because when you struggle and have difficulties with academics, he's there to listen to your rant and light up your mood and at the same time also help him with his work as well. And then as for if the relationship changed you, you mentioned that yes, it changed you because the relationship is somehow light to handle. And as for your partner, it also changed the relationship because even other people can notice it. And then he's very consistent. You also mentioned na you also feels safe not only physically but also emotionally because he can freely open up anything about him, anything for anything. And then he's your [Character], he also mentioned. And then as for rating the item, you rated 9 for the statement, your partner listens to you because he keeps in mind even keeping it in a notebook or in his brain and he listens and just doesn't judge you. And then he's also responsive to your needs. You rated also 9 even if you don't have one, there's an extra mile to be responsive to your needs. And then as for your physical intimacy, you're clingy but you haven't had sex yet. But you rated your sex life as also 9. And then in general, you rated 10 for both questions about your satisfaction in the relationship because you couldn't ask for more. But you're also not expecting just going with the flow but it currently fulfills your relationship. So was that right or is there anything you'd like to add? Or ano?

Speaker: Okay, so thank you so much, [Participant's Name]. Thank you so much, [Participant's Name]. Now, before we end, I also want to talk about the data sharing options of this research project. So we'll talk about how we handle the data. We want to be as ethically transparent as possible, of course. And I'd like to ask you about the most comfortable data sharing option for you. So we have two options. So option number one is the transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you. So the de-identified transcript can also be read by other researchers. So portions lang of the transcript. But option number two, if you're a bit bolder, you can share the whole transcript. But of course, removing sensitive or details that may be used to identify you. So although in this option, there's a very minimal chance that someone, you know, can piece all the details and identify that it's you. But it would take time. It would take some time for them because they have to read the appendices. They have to read the supplement materials. But there's a minimal chance, but very, very minimal. And again, no sensitive information will be shared. So with these options, again, option one, portions lang, option number two, the whole transcript, can we ask which are you more comfortable with?

Speaker: Kahit ano na lang siguro po. As long as makahelp sa research.

Interviewer: Okay. That's good to hear. So we can have either way for you. Okay. So again, thank you so much for participating. I'd like you to know that this study is also done, not only in the Philippines, but also in Brazil, in Turkey, in France, and in the US. Multi-country siya. And for this study to be successful, we'll ask one more thing. One more thing for you if that's okay. So can you recommend two nominators

or two close people as nominators? We'll ask them for additional couples that we can interview for this study. So in that way, because we can get as diverse and as broad as possible, so network. So can you recommend two close friends or someone you know that can recommend us couples? So yung dalawa, they'll provide us couples to interview.

Speaker: I'll ask my friends.

Interviewer: Okay. So feel free to send them anytime.

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: And then give them a heads up lang so that they won't block us when we contact them.

Speaker: Okay.

Interviewer: So I'll be ending the recording in a while.